

LRS Seminar & Report

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Some Good Resources for LRS

- Chris Hart, “Doing a Literature Review - Releasing the research imagination” 2nd Edition, SAGE Publishers, Delhi 2018
- Arelene Fink, “Conducting Research Literature Reviews - From the internet to paper”, 5th Edition, SAGE Publishers, Delhi, 2020.
- Robert L. Jolles, “How to Run Seminars and Workshops”, Wiley, 2005
- Christine Harrington and Theresa Orosz, “Why the First-Year Seminar Matters: Helping Students Choose and Stay on a Career Path”, Rowman Littlefield Publishers, 2018.

Summary of Literature Review

- What is literature review ?
- Significance of literature review
- Steps for literature review
- Summarizing and synthesizing
- Critical review
- Identifying gaps
- Research questions

Organization for Seminar

- Introduction
- Research article vs presentation
- Need, significance and art of good presentation
- Significance of time, engaging audience and invoking questions
- General vs research; state of the art vs research presentation
- Steps in preparing slide deck, good vs bad slide
- Measures of a good presentation

Introduction

- **Before :** Course work, comprehensive, literature review, research exploration, research articles/ patents.
- **Presentation:** Meant for Committee, non-specialists, etc. Lucid and highlighting only important achievements.
- **Report:** Ex. Synopsis Report. Meant for external examiners/ group / funding agency. Different organization compared to research article. But can significantly reuse materials from articles.
- **Thesis:** A novel that is connected from Title to last page. Writing story by taking help from literature review and published articles. Different than attaching articles. However can significantly reuse material from your published research article(s).

Research Article vs Presentation

- Specialists vs non-specialists
- Research arguments vs highlights
- Need not be lucid vs lucid
- Detailed vs gist
- Lengthy vs crispy
- Mostly text vs multimedia (figures, tables, audio-video)

Need for Presentation

- Presenting research work to semi-specialists or non-specialists
- How to improve lucidity compared to research article?
- Multimedia way of presenting work
- Illustrations to drive home message
- Keep time factor in mind - 10 mt, 15 mt, 20 mt, 45 mt?
- Convincing audience about work done
- Follow some good presentation preparation skills

Significance of Good Presentation

- More clarifications / questions from audience
- Helps to spot missing link in the work from non-specialists view
- Suggestions for future work
- Audience react based on what you have projected in slides!
- More time on deciding what to put and what to eliminate
- Less text, more figures and tables, spread out, non-redundant - pleasing to audience

Art of Good Presentation

- Slide deck is attractive
- Mannerism and preparedness
- Making audience attentive
- Ensuring audience enter deep listening phase
- Keep track of time
- Driving home message

Slide deck Preparation

- Thumb rule - 1 slide / minute
- No. of slides = duration of presentation (mts) - 2/3
- Outline - story - skeletal slides
- Filling slides - screenplay
- Min text, can I replace text with figures / tables?
- Can I prune remaining text?
- Information on slide deck is only to help you to give clue
- Audience should listen to you and then refer to slide deck

Mannerism and Preparedness

- Well dressed
- Eager to present
- Proper body language
- Arrive in advance and setup
- Technical tools in place, computing machine, projector, slides projected at proper visibility, mic connected properly
- Mic at proper distance from mouth to have comfortable level of audio
- Voice modulation, emphasizing / stressing, summarizing ...
- Don't panic - plan B / plan C, worst case, speak without slides



Making Audience Attentive

- Eye contact, smiling face, eagerness to convey
- Voice modulation at right level
- Proper speaking rate with enough pauses
- Interplay of voice, information in slide, eye contact with audience
- Gauging audience whether attentive or not
- Mid course correction for bringing back their attention

Deep Listening by Audience

- Create interest in audience about your work
- Should be attracted like watching a movie
- Ensure you pause and summarize at regular intervals
- Predict from your eyes whether audience are with you or not
- Take measures to get them interested in your work
- Summarize the work
- Acknowledgment of others
- Take off, in the sky and then landing



Timing

- Time is most precious, don't overshoot or otherwise
- Same content can be conveyed at different time durations
- Multi-resolution approach
- Rehearse, rehearse, rehearse!
- While rehearsing, keep track of time and modify your take off, in the sky and landing times
- 10% for take off, 10% for landing, 80% for in the sky
- 10 mt (1 mt, 8 mt, 1 mt), 15 mt (1.5 mt, 12 mt, 1.5 mt), ...



Driving Home Message

- You have a one-point agenda that drives home the message!
- Title, intro, main body, summary - all geared towards driving message
- Eager to convey, be receptive to take questions
- Understanding question completes 50%
- Answering correctly is rest 50%
- Correct or guess - mention, don't give wrong answer
- Note down good questions

Organization for Report Writing

- Introduction
- Research article vs report
- Need, significance and art of good report
- Significance of lucidity, different organization and less time to get grip
- General vs research; state of the art vs research report
- Steps in preparing report, good vs bad report
- Measures of a good report

Introduction

- **Research Article** : Meant for specialist, hypothesis, novelty, experiments / proof, analysis of results/ proof, summary and conclusions.
- **Report**: SoAS report, periodic review report, synopsis or open seminar report. Meant for committee / external examiners/ funding agency. Different organization compared to research article. But can significantly reuse materials from articles.
- **Thesis**: A novel that is connected from Title to last page. Writing story by taking help from literature review and published articles. Different than attaching articles. However can significantly reuse material from your published research article(s).

Research Article vs Report

- Specialist vs semi-specialist / non-specialist
- **Tone or projection** Argumentative vs reporting
- Motivation to sell novelty vs summative of work done and progress made
- Easy for specialist vs semi-specialist / non-specialist to read and get sense of work done
- Get to understand for what purpose you are preparing report
- Organize your report accordingly

Need for Report

- Periodic summarizing work done
- Meant for bringing more visibility to group research activity, within and outside organization
- Meant for funding agencies to assess progress
- Meant for external examiners to get gist of work
- Demystifying and making information more readable from semi-specialists / non-specialist point of view

Significance of Good Report

- Captures all important findings in a summative form
- Relatively easier to follow
- Get measure of progress made
- Readers get an idea about novelty, quality and amount of work done!
- Helps in making material more oriented towards thesis writing
- It is like story writing as opposed to novel in case of PhD
- Follow some good report preparation skills

Art of Good Report Preparation

- Ask for the purpose and intended audience, prepare organizing template for the same
- Take your research diary, research articles and collect material
- Collect information and include in the template
- Check, recheck for lucidity and completeness
- One test - information in report should be sufficient to prepare your slide deck for presentation or otherwise

Measures of Good Report

- Well organized
- Easy to follow
- Reading a story
- Completeness
- Optimal length for the report
- Appreciate work reported

Thank You